

April 17, 1975. The soldiers were a mixture of fighters who had been at war in the countryside for years and young peasants with no concept of urban life, abducted and recruited by the Khmer Rouge. Glad that the Lon Nol regime was gone, many citizens came out in the streets to welcome the rebels—but their hopes for an end to strife were quickly dashed.

“We are **entering the capital by force of arms.**”

THE KHMER ROUGE INTERRUPT A GOVERNMENT BROADCAST, APRIL 17, 1975



Operation Eagle Pull

April 12, 1975 saw the final evacuation of US nationals and Cambodian allies to ships in the Gulf of Thailand. Several Cambodian officials refused to leave the city, even though the Khmer Rouge had marked them for execution.